

Individuals using the Internet (% of population)

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Metadata information

Information on metadata

Document title

Metadata for Individuals using the Internet (% of population)

Document ID

META_WB_WDI_IT_NET_USER_ZS

Metadata producers

Name	Abbreviation	Affiliation
Development Economics Data Group	DECDG	World Bank

Version

1.1.1

Version notes

Updated metadata ID for consistency with indicator code.

Version date

2026-05-06

Indicator description

Title statement

Indicator code

WB_WDI_IT_NET_USER_ZS

Indicator name

Individuals using the Internet (% of population)

Alternate identifiers

Type	Identifier	Database	URL	Notes
	Individuals using the Internet	ITU Data Hub	https://datahub.itu.int/	
DCS code	IT.NET.USER.ZS	DCS		Identifier in DCS database

Database ID

WB_WDI

Database name

World Development Indicators (WDI)

Language

Name	Code
English	EN

Version date

2026-07-01

Description

Definition

Internet users are individuals who have used the Internet (from any location) in the last 3 months. The Internet can be used via a computer, mobile phone, personal digital assistant, games machine, digital TV etc.

Definition references

Source	URL
International Telecommunication Union	https://www.itu.int/en/ITU-D/Statistics/Pages/publications/manual.aspx

Development relevance

The digital and information revolution has changed the way the world learns, communicates, does business, and treats illnesses. New information and communications technologies (ICT) offer vast opportunities for progress in all walks of life in all countries - opportunities for economic growth, improved health, better service delivery, learning through distance education, and social and cultural advances.

Today's smartphones and tablets have computer power equivalent to that of yesterday's computers and provide a similar range of functions. Device convergence is thus rendering the conventional definition obsolete.

Comparable statistics on access, use, quality, and affordability of ICT are needed to formulate growth-enabling policies for the sector and to monitor and evaluate the sector's impact on development. Although basic access data are available for many countries, in most developing countries little is known about who uses ICT; what they are used for (school, work, business, research, government); and how they affect people and businesses. The global Partnership on Measuring ICT for Development is helping to set standards, harmonize information and communications technology statistics, and build statistical capacity in developing countries. However, despite significant improvements in the developing world, the gap between the ICT haves and have-nots remains.

Measurement unit

% of population

Dimensions

Label	Description
Year	
Geographic area	Country/economy, country group, region

Periodicity

Annual

Topics

ID	Label	Parent ID	Vocabulary	URL
	Infrastructure: Communications		WDI topics	
P5	Digital		WB Practice Groups	https://fmr.worldbank.org/FMR/sdmx/v2/structure/hierarchy/WB.DATA360/H_D360_TOPICS/1.0
P5_000004	Digital Services	P5	Data360 Topic L1	https://fmr.worldbank.org/FMR/sdmx/v2/structure/hierarchy/WB.DATA360/H_D360_TOPICS/1.0

Notes

Note
Please cite the International Telecommunication Union for third-party use of these data.

Links

Type	Description	URL
WDI API	Data in JSON	https://api.worldbank.org/v2/countries/all/indicators/it.net.user.zs?date=1960:2022&format=json
WDI API	Data in XML	https://api.worldbank.org/v2/countries/all/indicators/it.net.user.zs?date=1960:2022
WDI API	Metadata in JSON	https://api.worldbank.org/v2/sources/2/series/it.net.user.zs/metadata?format=json
WDI API	Metadata in XML	https://api.worldbank.org/v2/sources/2/series/it.net.user.zs/metadata

Quality

Limitations

Operators have traditionally been the main source of telecommunications data, so information on subscriptions has been widely available for most countries. This gives a general idea of access, but a more precise measure is the penetration rate - the share of households with access to telecommunications. During the past few years more information on information and communication technology use has become available from household and business surveys. Also important are data on actual use of telecommunications services. Ideally, statistics on telecommunications (and other information and communications technologies) should be compiled for all three measures: subscriptions, access, and use. The quality of data varies among reporting countries as a result of differences in regulations covering data provision and availability.

Discrepancies may also arise in cases where the end of a fiscal year differs from that used by ITU, which is the end of December of every year. A number of countries have fiscal years that end in March or June of every year.

Concepts and methods

Statistical concept

The number of in-scope individuals using the Internet is calculated by aggregating the weighted responses. The proportion of individuals using the Internet is expressed as a percentage and is calculated by dividing the total number of in-scope individuals using the Internet by the total number of in-scope individuals, and then multiplying the result by 100.

Methodology

The Internet is a world-wide public computer network. It provides access to a number of communication

services including the World Wide Web and carries email, news, entertainment and data files, irrespective of the device used (not assumed to be only via a computer - it may also be by mobile phone, PDA, games machine, digital TV etc.). Access can be via a fixed or mobile network. For additional/latest information on sources and country notes, please also refer to:

<https://www.itu.int/en/ITU-D/Statistics/Pages/stat/default.aspx>

Aggregation method

Weighted average

Geographic and time coverage

Time coverage

Start	End
1990	2025

Economies

Name	Code
Aruba	ABW
Afghanistan	AFG
Angola	AGO
Albania	ALB
United Arab Emirates	ARE
Andorra	AND
Armenia	ARM
Argentina	ARG
American Samoa	ASM
Antigua and Barbuda	ATG
Australia	AUS
Austria	AUT
Azerbaijan	AZE
Burundi	BDI
Belgium	BEL
Burkina Faso	BFA
Benin	BEN
Bangladesh	BGD
Bahrain	BHR
Belarus	BLR
Bosnia and Herzegovina	BIH
Belize	BLZ
Bermuda	BMU
Bulgaria	BGR
Bolivia	BOL
Brazil	BRA
Barbados	BRB

Brunei Darussalam	BRN
Bhutan	BTN
Bahamas, The	BHS
Central African Republic	CAF
Botswana	BWA
Canada	CAN
Switzerland	CHE
Chile	CHL
China	CHN
Cameroon	CMR
Congo, Dem. Rep.	COD
Colombia	COL
Cabo Verde	CPV
Costa Rica	CRI
Comoros	COM
Cuba	CUB
Curaçao	CUW
Cyprus	CYP
Côte d'Ivoire	CIV
Czechia	CZE
Djibouti	DJI
Dominica	DMA
Dominican Republic	DOM
Congo, Rep.	COG
Denmark	DNK
Algeria	DZA
Germany	DEU
Cayman Islands	CYM
Egypt, Arab Rep.	EGY
Ecuador	ECU
Ethiopia	ETH
Estonia	EST
Eritrea	ERI
Finland	FIN
France	FRA
Fiji	FJI
Faroe Islands	FRO
Micronesia, Fed. Sts.	FSM
Spain	ESP
Gabon	GAB
Georgia	GEO
Gibraltar	GIB

Ghana	GHA
Guinea	GIN
Guinea-Bissau	GNB
United Kingdom	GBR
Gambia, The	GMB
Grenada	GRD
Greenland	GRL
Equatorial Guinea	GNQ
Guatemala	GTM
Guam	GUM
Croatia	HRV
Guyana	GUY
Hong Kong SAR, China	HKG
Honduras	HND
Greece	GRC
Haiti	HTI
Hungary	HUN
Indonesia	IDN
Iraq	IRQ
Ireland	IRL
Iran, Islamic Rep.	IRN
Israel	ISR
Iceland	ISL
Italy	ITA
Jamaica	JAM
Japan	JPN
Kazakhstan	KAZ
India	IND
Kenya	KEN
Cambodia	KHM
Kyrgyz Republic	KGZ
Korea, Rep.	KOR
Kuwait	KWT
Lao PDR	LAO
Jordan	JOR
Lebanon	LBN
Liberia	LBR
St. Lucia	LCA
St. Kitts and Nevis	KNA
Liechtenstein	LIE
Lithuania	LTU
Sri Lanka	LKA

Kiribati	KIR
Latvia	LVA
Luxembourg	LUX
Lesotho	LSO
Moldova	MDA
Libya	LBY
Morocco	MAR
Monaco	MCO
Mexico	MEX
Madagascar	MDG
Mali	MLI
Montenegro	MNE
Malta	MLT
Marshall Islands	MHL
Myanmar	MMR
North Macedonia	MKD
Mozambique	MOZ
Mauritania	MRT
Macao SAR, China	MAC
New Caledonia	NCL
Malaysia	MYS
Northern Mariana Islands	MNP
Mauritius	MUS
Malawi	MWI
Maldives	MDV
Norway	NOR
Nepal	NPL
Oman	OMN
Nigeria	NGA
Nicaragua	NIC
New Zealand	NZL
Mongolia	MNG
Pakistan	PAK
Papua New Guinea	PNG
Puerto Rico	PRI
Namibia	NAM
Panama	PAN
Paraguay	PRY
Palau	PLW
Peru	PER
Niger	NER
Poland	POL

Netherlands	NLD
West Bank and Gaza	PSE
French Polynesia	PYF
Korea, Dem. People's Rep.	PRK
Romania	ROU
Nauru	NRU
Qatar	QAT
Saudi Arabia	SAU
Philippines	PHL
Senegal	SEN
Rwanda	RWA
San Marino	SMR
Serbia	SRB
Sudan	SDN
Singapore	SGP
South Sudan	SSD
Portugal	PRT
Solomon Islands	SLB
Sierra Leone	SLE
Sweden	SWE
São Tomé and Príncipe	STP
Russian Federation	RUS
Slovak Republic	SVK
Suriname	SUR
Syrian Arab Republic	SYR
Slovenia	SVN
Eswatini	SWZ
Turks and Caicos Islands	TCA
El Salvador	SLV
Somalia, Federal Republic of	SOM
Thailand	THA
Seychelles	SYC
Chad	TCD
Tajikistan	TJK
Timor-Leste	TLS
Turkmenistan	TKM
Trinidad and Tobago	TTO
Türkiye	TUR
Tunisia	TUN
Tonga	TON
Uganda	UGA
Uruguay	URY

Tuvalu	TUV
Togo	TGO
Venezuela, RB	VEN
United States	USA
Ukraine	UKR
Tanzania	TZA
British Virgin Islands	VGB
Yemen, Rep.	YEM
Vietnam	VNM
Zambia	ZMB
Kosovo	XXK
Zimbabwe	ZWE
Samoa	WSM
South Africa	ZAF
St. Vincent and the Grenadines	VCT
Virgin Islands (U.S.)	VIR
Uzbekistan	UZB
Vanuatu	VUT

Geographic areas

Name	Code
Africa Eastern and Southern	AFE
Africa Western and Central	AFW
East Asia & Pacific (excluding high income)	EAP
East Asia & Pacific	EAS
Europe & Central Asia (excluding high income)	ECA
Europe & Central Asia	ECS
Fragile and conflict affected situations	FCS
High income	HIC
IDA total	IDA
IBRD only	IBD
IDA & IBRD total	IBT
IDA blend	IDB
IDA only	IDX
Latin America & Caribbean (excluding high income)	LAC
Least developed countries: UN classification	LDC
Latin America & Caribbean	LCN
Low income	LIC
Lower middle income	LMC
Middle East, North Africa, Afghanistan & Pakistan	MEA
Middle East, North Africa, Afghanistan & Pakistan (excluding high income)	MNA
North America	NAC

South Asia	SAS
Europe & Central Asia (IDA & IBRD)	TEC
Sub-Saharan Africa (excluding high income)	SSA
East Asia & Pacific (IDA & IBRD)	TEA
Sub-Saharan Africa	SSF
Small states	SST
Middle East, North Africa, Afghanistan & Pakistan (IDA & IBRD)	TMN
South Asia (IDA & IBRD)	TSA
Sub-Saharan Africa (IDA & IBRD)	TSS
Upper middle income	UMC
Latin America & Caribbean (IDA & IBRD)	TLA
World	WLD

Access and use

License

Name	URL
CC BY-4.0	https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/

Confidentiality status

PU

API documentation

Description	URL
Developer Information webpage (detailed documentation of the WDI API)	https://datahelpdesk.worldbank.org/knowledgebase/topics/125589-developer-information

Sources and citation

Sources of data

Sources of data

Title

World Telecommunication/ICT Indicators Database

Author (Organization)

International Telecommunication Union (ITU)

Electronic location or identifier

<https://datahub.itu.int/>

Tags

Tags

Tag	Tag group
WB_WDI	feature-dataset-profile
LCN	overview-region-profile-region
P5	overview-region-profile-pillar
P5	benchmark-region-profile-pillar
P5	feature-region-profile-pillar